

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Tropical storm

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Treat tropical storm warnings seriously: dangerous flooding, surge, wind and tornadoes can occur. Check local evacuation instructions, avoid flooded roads, and take shelter before conditions become unsafe.

Do now.

**Read all warnings**

01

Check flood, surge and tornado notices as well as wind forecasts.

**Prepare before arrival**

02

Charge devices, secure loose outdoor items while safe and arrange essential medicines and supplies.

**Leave if ordered**

03

Follow the evacuation zone and route instructions for your address.

**Keep travel limited**

04

Stay off roads during hazardous weather and never drive into floodwater.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Prepare for loss of water, electricity and communications even if the storm is not a hurricane. Move out of flood and surge areas before access is lost. Do not use the storm name or wind category as proof that your route or home is safe.

Watch for.

A storm below hurricane strength can still cause catastrophic flooding.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area. Decide who helps whom and who carries the essential supplies; do not send a lone child to retrieve items. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: read all warnings. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. A storm below hurricane strength can still cause catastrophic flooding.

Keep essentials within reach.

For tropical storm, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Prepare for loss of water, electricity and communications even if the storm is not a hurricane. Move out of flood and surge areas before access is lost. Do not use the storm name or wind category as proof that your route or home is safe. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Monitor updates after the storm passes; rivers may keep rising and power lines may remain live.

First decision: Read all warnings

Check flood, surge and tornado notices as well as wind forecasts. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Prepare for loss of water, electricity and communications even if the storm is not a hurricane. Move out of flood and surge areas before access is lost. Do not use the storm name or wind category as proof that your route or home is safe. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

A storm below hurricane strength can still cause catastrophic flooding. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Treat tropical storm warnings seriously: dangerous flooding, surge, wind and tornadoes can occur. Check local evacuation instructions, avoid flooded roads, and take shelter before conditions become unsafe. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For tropical storm, keep the specific hazard in view: A storm below hurricane strength can still cause catastrophic flooding.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Keep travel limited. Stay off roads during hazardous weather and never drive into floodwater. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Tropical storm · official guidance

<https://www.weather.gov/safety/hurricane>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/tropical-storm/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.